Books of the Bible Memory System

How every child memorizes, spells, reads, and finds all **66 books of the Bible** in 12 months.

1. The Big Picture: The Bible Is a Library

Teach this on Day 1 and repeat it every month:

> **The Bible is ONE book made of 66 little books, like a library on a shelf.** It has **2 big parts**: the **Old Testament** (39 books, before Jesus was born) and the **New Testament** (27 books, Jesus and His church). Trick to remember: **3 and 9 = 39. 3 × 9 = 27.** Together they make **66**!

The 10 "Shelves" (Sections) of the Bible Library

Each section has a color, which is used on the flashcards, the classroom "Bible Bookshelf" wall, and the printables.

#	Section	Books	Color	Hand sign	Kid meaning
1	**Law**	5	🟥 Red	Two flat hands like stone tablets	"God's rules and the beginning"
2	**History** (OT)	12	🟧 Orange	Point behind you ("long ago")	"What happened to God's people"
3	**Poetry & Wisdom**	5	🟨 Yellow	Hand on heart	"Songs and smart sayings"
4	**Major Prophets**	5	🟩 Green	Big megaphone hands	"God's BIG messengers (long books)"
5	**Minor Prophets**	12	🟦 Light Blue	Small megaphone (one hand)	"God's mini messengers (short books)"
6	**Gospels**	4	🟪 Purple	Arms make a cross	"Good News about Jesus"
7	**History** (NT): Acts	1	🟫 Brown	Hands blow like wind (the Holy Spirit)	"The church is born"
8	**Paul's Letters**	13	🔵 Dark Blue	Write on your palm	"Letters from Paul"
9	**General Letters**	8	⚬ Gray	Open an envelope	"Letters from other leaders"
10	**Prophecy**: Revelation	1	🟡 Gold	Crown on your head	"Jesus wins forever!"

Section count chant (clap on each number):

> "Law has **5**, History **12**, Poetry **5**, Prophets **5 and 12**! Gospels **4**, Acts is **1**, Paul wrote **13**, more letters **8**, Revelation **1**: Sixty-six and DONE!"

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2. Master List of All 66 Books

Use this table to make flashcards, check spelling, and teach pronunciation. **Syllables** are separated with dots for clapping. The **"Phase"** column shows when each book is taught.

Old Testament (39)

#	Book	Say it	Syllables (clap)	Spell it	Section	Phase
1	Genesis	JEN-uh-sis	Gen·e·sis (3)	G-E-N-E-S-I-S	Law	1
2	Exodus	EK-suh-dus	Ex·o·dus (3)	E-X-O-D-U-S	Law	2
3	Leviticus	luh-VIT-ih-kus	Le·vit·i·cus (4)	L-E-V-I-T-I-C-U-S	Law	2
4	Numbers	NUM-burz	Num·bers (2)	N-U-M-B-E-R-S	Law	2
5	Deuteronomy	doo-tur-AH-nuh-mee	Deu·ter·on·o·my (5)	D-E-U-T-E-R-O-N-O-M-Y	Law	2
6	Joshua	JOSH-oo-uh	Josh·u·a (3)	J-O-S-H-U-A	History	3
7	Judges	JUJ-iz	Judg·es (2)	J-U-D-G-E-S	History	3
8	Ruth	ROOTH	Ruth (1)	R-U-T-H	History	3
9	1 Samuel	First SAM-yoo-ul	Sam·u·el (3)	1 S-A-M-U-E-L	History	4
10	2 Samuel	Second SAM-yoo-ul	Sam·u·el (3)	2 S-A-M-U-E-L	History	4
11	1 Kings	First KINGZ	Kings (1)	1 K-I-N-G-S	History	4
12	2 Kings	Second KINGZ	Kings (1)	2 K-I-N-G-S	History	4
13	1 Chronicles	First KRAH-nih-kulz	Chron·i·cles (3)	1 C-H-R-O-N-I-C-L-E-S	History	4
14	2 Chronicles	Second KRAH-nih-kulz	Chron·i·cles (3)	2 C-H-R-O-N-I-C-L-E-S	History	4
15	Ezra	EZ-ruh	Ez·ra (2)	E-Z-R-A	History	5
16	Nehemiah	nee-uh-MY-uh	Ne·he·mi·ah (4)	N-E-H-E-M-I-A-H	History	5
17	Esther	ES-tur	Es·ther (2)	E-S-T-H-E-R	History	5
18	Job	JOBE (rhymes with "robe")	Job (1)	J-O-B	Poetry	6
19	Psalms	SAHMZ (the P is silent!)	Psalms (1)	P-S-A-L-M-S	Poetry	6
20	Proverbs	PRAH-vurbz	Prov·erbs (2)	P-R-O-V-E-R-B-S	Poetry	6

#	Book	Say it	Syllables (clap)	Spell it	Section	Phase
21	Ecclesiastes	ih-klee-zee-AS-teez	Ec·cle·si·as·tes (5)	E-C-C-L-E-S-I-A-S-T-E-S	Poetry	6
22	Song of Songs	SONG uv SONGZ	Song of Songs (3)	S-O-N-G O-F S-O-N-G-S	Poetry	6
23	Isaiah	eye-ZAY-uh	I·sai·ah (3)	I-S-A-I-A-H	Major Prophets	7
24	Jeremiah	jair-uh-MY-uh	Jer·e·mi·ah (4)	J-E-R-E-M-I-A-H	Major Prophets	7
25	Lamentations	lam-un-TAY-shunz	Lam·en·ta·tions (4)	L-A-M-E-N-T-A-T-I-O-N-S	Major Prophets	7
26	Ezekiel	ih-ZEE-kee-ul	E·ze·ki·el (4)	E-Z-E-K-I-E-L	Major Prophets	7
27	Daniel	DAN-yul	Dan·iel (2)	D-A-N-I-E-L	Major Prophets	7
28	Hosea	ho-ZAY-uh	Ho·se·a (3)	H-O-S-E-A	Minor Prophets	8
29	Joel	JOE-ul	Jo·el (2)	J-O-E-L	Minor Prophets	8
30	Amos	AY-mus	A·mos (2)	A-M-O-S	Minor Prophets	8
31	Obadiah	oh-buh-DY-uh	O·ba·di·ah (4)	O-B-A-D-I-A-H	Minor Prophets	8
32	Jonah	JOE-nuh	Jo·nah (2)	J-O-N-A-H	Minor Prophets	8
33	Micah	MY-kuh	Mi·cah (2)	M-I-C-A-H	Minor Prophets	8
34	Nahum	NAY-hum	Na·hum (2)	N-A-H-U-M	Minor Prophets	8
35	Habakkuk	huh-BAK-uk	Ha·bak·kuk (3)	H-A-B-A-K-K-U-K	Minor Prophets	8
36	Zephaniah	zef-uh-NY-uh	Zeph·a·ni·ah (4)	Z-E-P-H-A-N-I-A-H	Minor Prophets	8
37	Haggai	HAG-eye	Hag·gai (2)	H-A-G-G-A-I	Minor Prophets	8
38	Zechariah	zek-uh-RY-uh	Zech·a·ri·ah (4)	Z-E-C-H-A-R-I-A-H	Minor Prophets	8
39	Malachi	MAL-uh-kye	Mal·a·chi (3)	M-A-L-A-C-H-I	Minor Prophets	8

New Testament (27)

#	Book	Say it	Syllables (clap)	Spell it	Section	Phase
40	Matthew	MATH-yoo	Mat·thew (2)	M-A-T-T-H-E-W	Gospels	9
41	Mark	MARK	Mark (1)	M-A-R-K	Gospels	9
42	Luke	LOOK	Luke (1)	L-U-K-E	Gospels	9
43	John	JAHN	John (1)	J-O-H-N	Gospels	9
44	Acts	AKTS	Acts (1)	A-C-T-S	History (NT)	10
45	Romans	ROE-munz	Ro·mans (2)	R-O-M-A-N-S	Paul's Letters	11
46	1 Corinthians	First kor-IN-thee-unz	Co·rin·thi·ans (4)	1 C-O-R-I-N-T-H-I-A-N-S	Paul's Letters	11
47	2 Corinthians	Second kor-IN-thee-unz	Co·rin·thi·ans (4)	2 C-O-R-I-N-T-H-I-A-N-S	Paul's Letters	11
48	Galatians	guh-LAY-shunz	Ga·la·tians (3)	G-A-L-A-T-I-A-N-S	Paul's Letters	11
49	Ephesians	ih-FEE-zhunz	E·phe·sians (3)	E-P-H-E-S-I-A-N-S	Paul's Letters	11
50	Philippians	fih-LIP-ee-unz	Phi·lip·pi·ans (4)	P-H-I-L-I-P-P-I-A-N-S	Paul's Letters	11
51	Colossians	kuh-LOSH-unz	Co·los·sians (3)	C-O-L-O-S-S-I-A-N-S	Paul's Letters	11
52	1 Thessalonians	First thess-uh-LOE-nee-unz	Thes·sa·lo·ni·ans (5)	1 T-H-E-S-S-A-L-O-N-I-A-N-S	Paul's Letters	11
53	2 Thessalonians	Second thess-uh-LOE-nee-unz	Thes·sa·lo·ni·ans (5)	2 T-H-E-S-S-A-L-O-N-I-A-N-S	Paul's Letters	11
54	1 Timothy	First TIM-uh-thee	Tim·o·thy (3)	1 T-I-M-O-T-H-Y	Paul's Letters	11
55	2 Timothy	Second TIM-uh-thee	Tim·o·thy (3)	2 T-I-M-O-T-H-Y	Paul's Letters	11
56	Titus	TY-tus	Ti·tus (2)	T-I-T-U-S	Paul's Letters	11
57	Philemon	fy-LEE-mun	Phi·le·mon (3)	P-H-I-L-E-M-O-N	Paul's Letters	11
58	Hebrews	HEE-brooz	He·brews (2)	H-E-B-R-E-W-S	General Letters	12
59	James	JAYMZ	James (1)	J-A-M-E-S	General Letters	12

#	Book	Say it	Syllables (clap)	Spell it	Section	Phase
60	1 Peter	First PEE-tur	Pe·ter (2)	1 P-E-T-E-R	General Letters	12
61	2 Peter	Second PEE-tur	Pe·ter (2)	2 P-E-T-E-R	General Letters	12
62	1 John	First JAHN	John (1)	1 J-O-H-N	General Letters	12
63	2 John	Second JAHN	John (1)	2 J-O-H-N	General Letters	12
64	3 John	Third JAHN	John (1)	3 J-O-H-N	General Letters	12
65	Jude	JOOD	Jude (1)	J-U-D-E	General Letters	12
66	Revelation	rev-uh-LAY-shun	Rev·e·la·tion (4)	R-E-V-E-L-A-T-I-O-N	Prophecy	12

> ⚠️ **Common spelling traps**
>
> - Reve**lation** has **no "s"** at the end. It is *not* "Revelations."
> - **Ps**alms has a silent **P**.
> - **Ecc**lesiastes has a double **C**.
> - Habak**k**uk has a double **K**.
> - Phi**lipp**ians has one **L** and a double **P**.
> - Thess**alon**ians has a double **S**, then **alon**.
> - Colo**ss**ians has a double **S**.
> - Deu**ter**onomy starts with "Deu," not "Du."
> - Song of Songs is also called **Song of Solomon** in some Bibles. Teach both names.

3. The Cumulative Song

Each phase file has its own song, set to a familiar tune, with hand motions. **Every phase song is already cumulative**: it reviews all the books from earlier phases and then adds the new ones. Sing the current phase's song at the start of each class. The hand motions stay the same all year, even when the tune changes, so kids keep the same motion for each book from January to December.

For a single song that covers all 66 books at once, many churches use a well-known "Books of the Bible" tune (several are free on YouTube). Search **@SharefaithKids** for "books of the Bible song," and preview it first. Use whichever version your church already knows. The phase verses still teach the motions and sections.

Section-by-section chant (no tune needed, use a steady clap)

> **LAW** (5): Genesis, Exodus, Leviticus, Numbers, Deuteronomy! **HISTORY** (12): Joshua, Judges, Ruth, First and Second Samuel, First and Second Kings, First and Second Chronicles, Ezra, Nehemiah, Esther! **POETRY** (5): Job, Psalms, Proverbs, Ecclesiastes, Song of Songs! **MAJOR PROPHETS** (5): Isaiah, Jeremiah, Lamentations, Ezekiel, Daniel! **MINOR PROPHETS** (12): Hosea, Joel, Amos, Obadiah, Jonah, Micah, Nahum, Habakkuk, Zephaniah, Haggai, Zechariah, Malachi! **GOSPELS** (4): Matthew, Mark, Luke and John! **HISTORY** (1): Acts! **PAUL'S LETTERS** (13): Romans, First and Second Corinthians, Galatians, Ephesians, Philippians, Colossians, First and Second Thessalonians, First and Second Timothy, Titus, Philemon! **GENERAL LETTERS** (8): Hebrews, James, First and Second Peter, First, Second and Third John, Jude! **PROPHECY** (1): Revelation! **THE END, JESUS WINS!**

4. Memory Tricks & Mnemonics

Trick	Books	How it works
"Get Every Little Number Done"	Genesis, Exodus, Leviticus, Numbers, Deuteronomy	First letters G-E-L-N-D
"Jesus Just Rescued"	Joshua, Judges, Ruth	J-J-R
Twins	1 & 2 Samuel, Kings, Chronicles	"Three sets of twins: Sam, King, Chronicle." Hold up 2 fingers, three times
"Every Nice Exit"	Ezra, Nehemiah, Esther	E-N-E (they all came home from exile)
"Joyful Praise Prepares Every Song"	Job, Psalms, Proverbs, Ecclesiastes, Song of Songs	J-P-P-E-S
"I Just Love Eating Donuts"	Isaiah, Jeremiah, Lamentations, Ezekiel, Daniel	I-J-L-E-D
"Hosea Joel Amos, Obadiah Jonah Micah, Nahum Habakkuk Zephaniah, Haggai Zechariah Malachi"	Minor Prophets	Say them in 4 groups of 3, like a rhythm: *da-da-DA, da-da-DA*
"My Mom Likes Jesus"	Matthew, Mark, Luke, John	M-M-L-J
"Real Christians Can Go Every Place Carrying Ten Thousand Tiny Tracts To People"	Romans to Philemon	R-C-C-G-E-P-C-T-T-T-T-T-P, 13 words for 13 letters (Romans, 1 & 2 Corinthians, Galatians, Ephesians, Philippians, Colossians, 1 & 2 Thessalonians, 1 & 2 Timothy, Titus, Philemon)

Trick	Books	How it works
"Gee, Eat Pie Cold"	Galatians, Ephesians, Philippians, Colossians	G-E-P-C (the 4 middle letters; very popular!)
"He Just Prays, Prays; Just Just Just, Jesus Rules!"	Hebrews, James, 1–2 Peter, 1–3 John, Jude, Revelation	H-J-P-P-J-J-J-J-R

5. Classroom "Bible Bookshelf" Wall

Build a giant paper bookshelf on a wall with **10 shelves (one per section)**, each in its section color.

- Cut 66 "book spines" from colored cardstock (tall rectangles). Write one book name on each.
- When the class learns a book, a child **adds its spine to the shelf** in order.
- By December, the whole library is full: a visual celebration of the year!
- **Bonus:** Add a small picture symbol to each spine (from the phase file's "picture symbol").

6. Finding Books in a Real Bible ("Sword Drills")

> "For the word of God is alive and active. Sharper than any double-edged sword..." (Hebrews 4:12, NIV)

How to teach:

1. **Little Lambs:** Find the *middle* of the Bible (roughly Psalms). Find the *start* (Genesis) and the *big split* (Matthew).
2. **Explorers:** Use the Table of Contents, then try without it. Learn: "Old Testament is the front ¾, New Testament is the back ¼."
3. **Trailblazers & Ambassadors:** Timed Sword Drills.

Sword Drill rules:

1. "**Attention!**": Bibles closed, held at side.
2. "**Draw swords!**": Bibles held up flat, closed, hands on covers.
3. Leader calls a reference ("**Romans 8:28**") and repeats it.
4. "**CHARGE!**": Kids race to find it. First to find it **stands and reads it aloud**.
5. Points for the first three finders. Rotate so the same kid doesn't always win.

Book/chapter/verse: Teach "**John 3:16** = Book **John**, chapter **3** (the big number), verse **16** (the little number)."

7. Mastery Check-offs by Age Group

Use these at the end of each phase and in the final review. Record on the class chart and in each child's Bible Passport.

Level	🐑 Little Lambs	🧭 Explorers	🥾 Trailblazers	🕊️ Ambassadors
Say	Sing the song with the class	Say this phase's books alone	Say *all books so far* in order alone	Say all books so far in order + by section, alone, under 2 min by year end
Spell	Name the first letter of each new book	Spell this phase's books	Spell all books so far	Spell all books so far (written test)
Read	"Read" the flashcard picture and point to the word	Read the name on a flashcard	Read the book's key verse aloud	Read a passage and explain it
Find	Point to the Old or New Testament	Find the book using the Table of Contents	Find it in under 30 sec without the contents page	Win a Sword Drill round
Know	Tell one story from the phase	One-sentence summary per book	Summary + one key person per book	Explain how each book points to Jesus

8. Supporting Learners

- **Non-readers / early readers:** Use picture symbols, songs and motions, and "first-letter" spelling only.
- **Dyslexia or reading struggles:** Offer oral spelling, letter tiles or magnetic letters instead of writing, plus extra time. Never time them in front of others.
- **ADHD / high energy:** Pair memory work with movement (hopscotch spelling, toss-and-say).
- **English learners:** Pair with a buddy, use pictures, and celebrate the book names in their first language too.
- **Special needs:** Adapt the goal (e.g., recognize 5 books by picture) and celebrate progress. **Every child earns the badge for their personal best.**